

SOC101 SHORT HANDOUTS

FINAL TERM

Lesson 26 to 30

(SOC101)Introduction to Sociology

EFFORT BY VUHELPERS24 TEAM

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Lesson-26

THE FAMILY: GLOBAL VARIETY-II

Topic-142: Trends in Families: Divorce

What is the trend in divorce rates in societies like Pakistan?

Divorce rates are increasing, especially in urban areas and among better-educated and wealthier families.

What factors influence the rise in divorce rates in Pakistan?

Shifting cultural norms, women's increased economic independence, and easier access to legal assistance and support.

How is the divorce procedure governed in Pakistan?

The divorce procedure is governed by complex Islamic law.

What challenges do recent divorcees in Pakistan often face?

They may experience severe social embarrassment and find it difficult to find new love.

Topic-143: Single Parent Families

How have single-parent families evolved over the past few decades?

Single-parent families have advanced the most, with divorce or separation being the primary cause.

What are the effects of single-parent households on children, according to Thompson and Hickey (2016)?

Children from single-parent households are more likely to have behavioral issues, drop out of school, face legal problems, and experience health issues.

Topic-144: Blended Family

Define a blended family.

A blended family is formed when two divorced individuals remarry, bringing their children from previous marriages into the new household.

What challenges do blended families face?

They need to be resourceful and adaptable, dealing with the complexities of roles between biological parents and stepparents.

Contrary to common assumption, what is the reality about blended families losing their distinct identities?

Most blended families do not lose their distinct identities, sense of self, and emotional links to their birth families.

Topic-145: Same Sex families

How are same-sex families viewed in Western nations?

They are becoming more prevalent and accepted.

Why are same-sex relationships not recognized under Pakistani law?

They are deemed unconstitutional in Islamic philosophy.

Topic-146: Problems Related to Family: Balancing Family and Work

What percentage of married women with school-age children are employed, and what challenges do they face?

Nearly 75% are employed, and they face challenges in balancing family and work responsibilities.

What improvements have been observed in the division of childcare and household duties between men and women?

There has been an increase in fathers' involvement, but women still spend nearly twice as much time on childcare when both parents are at home.

Topic-147: Domestic Violence

What are the three basic categories of family violence according to sociologists?

Spousal, child, and elder abuse.

How prevalent is spousal abuse in the US, and what impact does it have on women?

Spousal abuse is one of the most common forms, and it has a more serious impact on women's well-being and control.

What is the prevalence of child abuse, and how has it changed over time?

Child abuse is relatively high, and reports have doubled between the early 1970s and mid-1990s.

What factors may contribute to a decline in family violence?

Factors include women's increased empowerment to leave abusive partners, the expansion of treatment and prevention programs, higher arrest rates, and tougher penalties for abusers.

Lesson-27

FUNCTIONS OF FAMILY

Topic-148: Reproduction and Union Formation

How do social norms and legal restrictions control reproduction and union formation?

Answer: Social norms and legal restrictions influence how people reproduce and establish unions, with different customs around courtship, dating, and marriage.

What factors are strongly connected with reproduction and union formation in many countries?

Answer: Social status, race, and religion are often strongly connected with reproduction and union formation.

How can economic factors impact the creation and growth of unions?

Answer: Economic factors such as employment and educational possibilities can have an impact on the creation and growth of unions.

Topic-149: Mate Selection

What is the process of choosing love relationships called?

Answer: The process is called mate selection.

What factors can influence the mate selection process?

Answer: Socioeconomic status, personality traits, physical attractiveness, family and social expectations, caste, religion, and family history can influence mate selection.

How might gender conventions affect the standards for choosing partners?

Answer: Men and women usually have different standards for choosing partners due to gender conventions.

Topic-150: Arranged Marriages

Who actively participates in selecting spouses in arranged marriages?

Answer: Parents or other family members actively participate in selecting spouses in arranged marriages.

Why are arranged marriages still common in many nations, including Pakistan?

Answer: Arranged marriages are seen as a way to ensure compatibility and strengthen family and community ties.

What role do economic factors play in arranged marriages?

Answer: Economic factors may be involved, as families may exchange gifts or dowries as part of arranged marriages.

Topic-151: Childcare and Child Rearing

In Pakistani culture, who is often seen as responsible for childcare?

Answer: Childcare is frequently seen as the mother's responsibility in Pakistani culture.

Besides parents, who commonly helps with childcare in Pakistani culture?

Answer: Grandparents, aunts, and uncles commonly help with childcare in Pakistani culture.

How are childcare and child-rearing influenced by religious and cultural standards?

Answer: Childcare and child-rearing are influenced by traditional gender standards, religious beliefs, and cultural norms in Pakistani homes.

Topic-152-153: Functions and Dysfunctions of Family: The Functionalist Perspective

According to functionalists, what tasks does the family perform for the society's survival?

Answer: The family performs crucial tasks such as defining sexual relations, conceiving new members, caring for the young and elderly, integrating new members, and assigning social statuses.

Why is the family considered a universal institution according to functionalists?

Answer: Functionalists argue that the family serves fundamental needs for the existence of society, including generating income, raising children, caring for the elderly and sick, having fun, controlling sexual urges, and procreating.

How does the incest taboo contribute to family stability according to functionalists?

Answer: The incest taboo helps avoid confusion over roles and relationships, facilitating easier socialization. It also encourages people to look outside their families for romantic partners.

What is one dysfunction of the nuclear family mentioned by functionalists?

Answer: The relative isolation of the nuclear family in modern culture is considered a dysfunction, leading to increased stress and emotional fatigue for family members.

Lesson-28

FAMILY AND MARRIAGE IN TRANSITION

Topic-154: Defining Marriage

What does marriage refer to?

Answer: Marriage refers to a group's approved mating arrangements, usually marked by a ritual, indicating the couple's new public status.

Topic-155: Meaning of Family and Marriage

How is a family defined?

Answer: A family is a social structure made up of people related by blood, marriage, or adoption, and it can take various forms such as single parent, nuclear, big, or any combination.

What is the expectation regarding marriage and family?

Answer: Marriage is generally seen as a way to start a new family unit with the expectation that the couple will eventually produce children.

Topic-156: The Conflict Perspective: Struggle between Husband and Wife

According to the conflict perspective, why is conflict inevitable in marriage?

Answer: Conflict in marriage is inevitable due to the shared aspects of life, differing objectives, and diverging worldviews between spouses.

What has historically been a major source of conflict between husbands and wives?

Answer: Power has historically been a major source of conflict, with females feeling that their husbands had more power.

Topic-157: The Symbolic Interactionist Perspective: Gender, Housework, and Childcare

What does the symbolic interactionist perspective emphasize?

Answer: The symbolic interactionist perspective emphasizes the importance of symbols and interactions in shaping social conduct.

How does this perspective relate to gender roles in Pakistan?

Answer: Symbolic interactionism helps understand how routine behavior in marriage generates and reinforces gender roles, such as men being expected to provide income while women handle household chores and childcare.

Topic-158: The Transformation of the Family

How did changes in traditional orientations affect men's involvement in household chores?

Answer: As more women began working for income, men felt compelled to assist with housework and childcare, challenging traditional gender roles.

What is observed regarding the time spent on housekeeping by husbands and wives?

Answer: Despite men doing more housework, the overall time spent on housekeeping by couples has reduced, suggesting changing attitudes towards housework.

Topic-159: Remarriage and Step Families

What influences the likelihood of divorce in second marriages?

Answer: The likelihood of divorce in second marriages is higher, especially for those with children from a later marriage.

Who is more likely to remarry, according to studies?

Answer: Men are more likely than women to remarry, possibly due to access to a wider range of potential spouses.

Topic-160: Child Custody Laws

What do child custody laws determine?

Answer: Child custody laws determine the care and control of a child when parents cannot agree, and in Pakistan, they often follow Islamic law, giving preference to mothers.

How can child custody laws highlight larger social issues?

Answer: Child custody laws can highlight broader social issues such as gender inequality and the treatment of marginalized groups, as seen in discussions around non-Muslim families or fathers in Pakistan.

Lesson-29

HEALTH AND MEDICINE-I

Topic-161: Sociology and the Study of Medicine and Health

What is the role of sociologists in the study of medicine and health?

Sociologists analyze how self-regulation, bureaucratic structure, and profit motivation are influenced by medicine.

Sociologists investigate non-biological factors affecting health, such as social class, cultural beliefs, and lifestyle.

Why is the sociology of medicine considered one of sociology's applied fields?

It emphasizes the practical application of sociological principles, with sociologists frequently employed by medical institutions.

Topic-162: The Symbolic Interactionist Perspective: The Role of Culture in Defining Health and Illness

How do cultural notions influence the definition of mental "illness" and "health"?

Cultural norms determine whether certain behaviors are considered "crazy" or "normal."

The terms "illness" and "health" are not absolutes but vary based on cultural definitions.

Topic-163: The Functionalist Perspective: The Sick Role

According to Talcott Parsons, what are the four aspects of the sick role?

1. Not held responsible for illness.
2. Excluded from regular responsibilities.
3. Dislike the sick role.
4. Have expert support to return to regular activities.

How do gender differences manifest in the sick role?

Women are more likely to play the sick role, seeking medical help more frequently than men.

Men often resist portraying the sick role due to cultural expectations.

Topic-164: The Conflict Perspective: Effects of Global Stratification on Health Care

What is the primary focus of the conflict perspective regarding health care?

The competition for scarce resources, with health care being one such resource.

How does global stratification impact medical care on a global scale?

Industrialized nations have access to advanced medical technologies, while less industrialized nations may lack these resources.

Diseases and life expectancy are influenced by global stratification, with disparities in access to treatments.

How does social stratification in least industrialized nations affect public health?

Scarce resources are often spent disproportionately on the rich class, leaving the less fortunate with limited access to basic medical treatment.

Improved water supplies and increased food production could significantly decrease leading causes of death, but resources are not allocated accordingly.

Lesson-30

HEALTH AND MEDICINE-II

Topic-165: The Medicalization of Society

What is medicalization, according to sociologists?

Medicalization is the process of turning non-medical issues into medical topics.

Give an example of medicalization discussed in the lesson.

Women's reproductive systems and childbirth being considered medical issues.

What does a symbolic interactionist perspective emphasize regarding medicalization?

Conditions like wrinkles, acne, etc., are not essentially medical; they are reinterpreted as medical issues.

According to conflict sociologists, what does the medicalization of various conditions demonstrate?

It demonstrates the growing authority and influence of the medical establishment.

What contentious topic is discussed in the lesson regarding medical professionals?

Medically assisted suicide and the authorization to provide fatal medications to those near death.

What are some contrasting opinions on medically assisted suicide mentioned in the lesson?

Some believe it lessens suffering, while others argue it makes murder legal.

Topic-166: Epidemiology: The Social Dimensions of Health

Define epidemiology.

Epidemiology is the study of the frequency and distribution of health and illness in a society.

Name the socioeconomic factors closely linked to health levels according to epidemiologists.

Age, sex, race and ethnicity, socioeconomic status.

Explain how age is related to health according to the lesson.

Americans live longer and in better health, but age-related diseases still exist, especially among the elderly.

What is the biggest health differential between men and women mentioned in the lesson?

The difference in life expectancy, with women outliving men by 7 to 10 years in the US.

How do race and ethnicity affect life expectancy in the United States?

On average, white people may live about 5 years longer than nonwhite people.

According to the lesson, what socioeconomic factor significantly affects health and quality of life?

Socioeconomic status, with those at the top having better health than those at the bottom.

Topic-167: Alternative Medicine: From Quackery to Integrative Health Care

What is alternative medicine, also known as?

Alternative medicine is also known as complementary or alternative medicine.

Why has alternative medicine historically faced skepticism?

Due to safety and effectiveness concerns, and many practices lacked scientific backing.

What is the shift in attitude towards alternative medicine mentioned in the lesson?

It has shifted from being considered quackery to being recognized as part of integrated healthcare.

Define integrative medicine.

Integrative medicine combines conventional medical procedures with evidence-based complementary and alternative therapies.

What is the purpose of ongoing research in alternative medicine?

To provide more evidence of the effectiveness and safety of complementary and alternative therapies.

What is the goal of integrative medicine, as mentioned in the lesson?

Integrative medicine seeks to provide complete and tailored care by combining the best elements of complementary and conventional therapy.

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